dissension within the work force and eliminating the advantages to the employee of collectivization. It also frees the employer from the possibility of facing conflicting demands from different unions, and permits the employer and a single union to reach agreements and settlements that are not subject to attack from rival labor organizations. See generally *Emporium Capwell Co.* v. *Western Addition Community Org., supra,* at 67–70; S. Rep. No. 573, 74th Cong., 1st Sess., 13 (1935).

The designation of a union as exclusive representative carries with it great responsibilities. The tasks of negotiating and administering a collective-bargaining agreement and representing the interests of employees in settling disputes and processing grievances are continuing and difficult ones. They often entail expenditure of much time and money. See *Street,* 367 U. S., at 760. The services of lawyers, expert negotiators, economists, and a research staff, as well as general administrative personnel, may be required. Moreover, in carrying out these duties, the union is obliged "fairly and equitably to represent all employees . . . , union and nonunion," within the relevant unit. *Id.,* at 761.[15] A union-

[15] See *Hines* v. *Anchor Motor Freight, Inc.,* 424 U. S. 554, 564:

"Because '[t]he collective bargaining system as encouraged by Congress and administered by the NLRB of necessity subordinates the interests of an individual employee to the collective interests of all employees in a bargaining unit,' *Vaca* v. *Sipes,* 386 U. S. 171, 182 (1967), the controlling statutes have long been interpreted as imposing upon the bargaining agent a responsibility equal in scope to its authority, 'the responsibility and duty of fair representation.' *Humphrey* v. *Moore, supra,* at 342. The union as the statutory representative of the employees is 'subject always to complete good faith and honesty of purpose in the exercise of its discretion.' *Ford Motor Co.* v. *Huffman,* [345 U. S. 330, 338]. Since *Steele* v. *Louisville & N. R. Co.,* 323 U. S. 192 (1944), with respect to the railroad industry, and *Ford Motor Co.* v. *Huffman, supra,* and *Syres* v. *Oil Workers,* 350 U. S. 892 (1955), with respect to those industries reached by the National Labor Relations Act, the duty of fair representation has served as a 'bulwark to prevent arbitrary union